

A SIMPLE VISUAL GUIDE

iCloud vs iPhone Storage

Why your phone says it's "out of storage" — and how the two are completely different.

PHOTO RESCUE by Geiger



iPhone



iCloud

They Are NOT the Same Thing

Two separate places your stuff can live. Either one can fill up on its own.



iPhone Storage

Think of it as YOUR HOUSE

The space physically inside your phone.

- Photos & videos
- Apps
- Messages
- Downloads

Full? Can't take photos, apps slow down, updates fail.



iCloud Storage

Think of it as a STORAGE LOCKER

Apple's online cloud storage — separate from your phone.

- Device backups
- Synced photos
- Documents
- Files across devices

Full? Backups stop, photos stop syncing, Apple asks you to upgrade.

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The Most Common Confusion

Your iPhone can have plenty of room WHILE your iCloud is completely full.

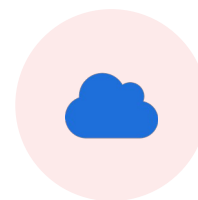


iPhone Storage

60 GB

FREE

✓ Plenty of room



iCloud Storage

0 GB

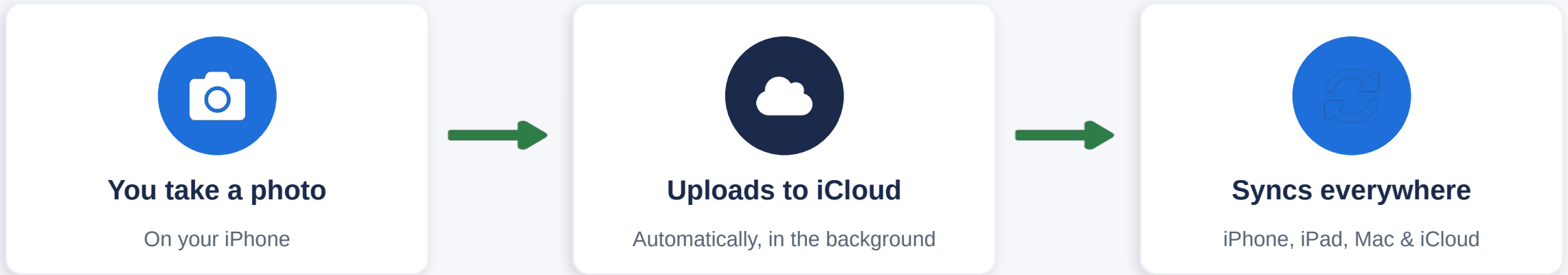
FREE

✗ Storage full

Same person. Same day. Two totally separate storage spaces.

Why iCloud Keeps Filling Up

When iCloud Photos is ON, every new photo uploads automatically — so it keeps growing over time.



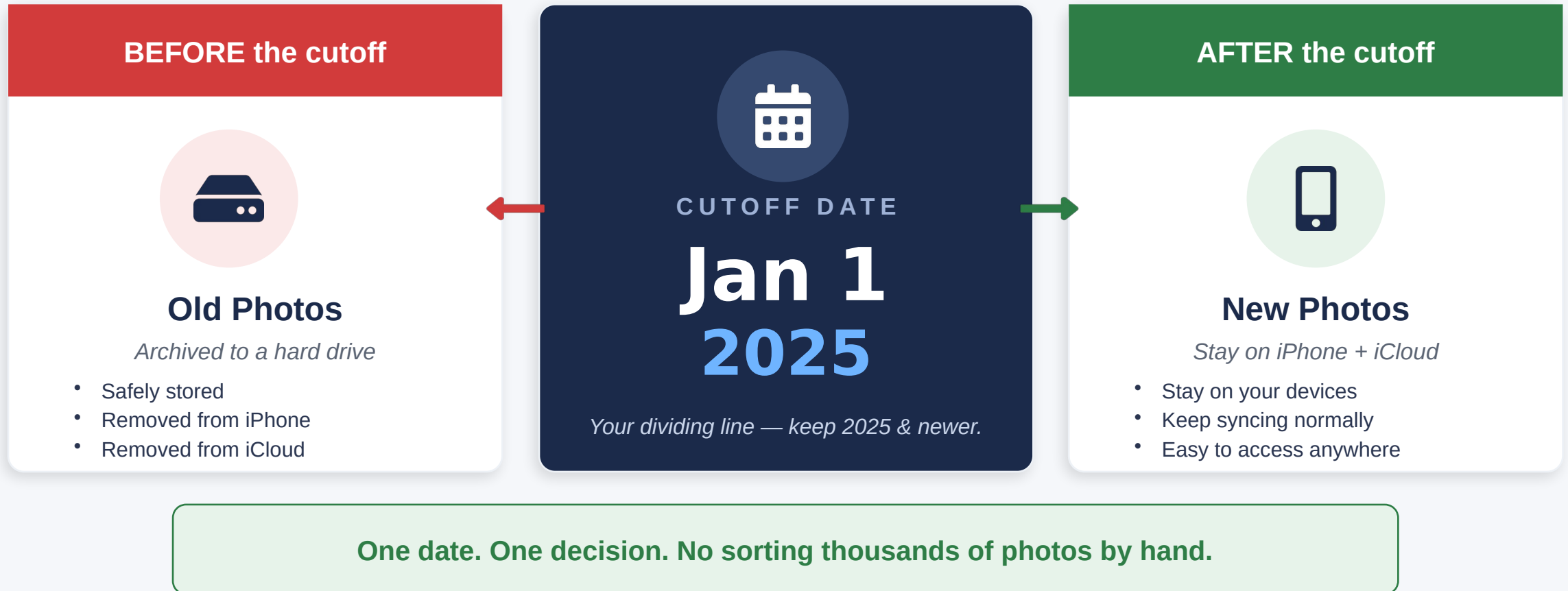
The Bathtub Analogy

You drain the tub (delete old photos), but the **faucet is still running** (iCloud Photos is ON). New photos and videos keep flowing in — so it fills right back up.

iCloud isn't refilling itself — new photos are continuously syncing into it.

The Smart Fix: A Photo Cutoff Date

Pick one date. Everything BEFORE it gets archived to a hard drive. Everything AFTER it stays on your phone.



How to Remove Photos Safely

Free up space without losing a single memory. Follow these five steps in order.



BACK UP FIRST. When iCloud Photos is ON, deleting a photo from iCloud also deletes it from your iPhone and every synced device. Never delete anything until it is safely copied and verified.

1



Copy to a Drive

Move photos & videos to a computer or external hard drive.

2



Verify Them

Open the files and confirm they are all there and not corrupt.

3



Turn Off Sync

Turn off iCloud Photos (if desired) so nothing re-uploads.

4



Delete Old Photos

Remove the photos you no longer need from iCloud & iPhone.

5



Empty 'Recently Deleted'

Clear that album to actually reclaim the storage space.

iCloud Photos is a sync service, not a backup — that's why Step 1 matters most.

Do You Really Need Lots of iCloud?

The more Apple devices you sync, the more valuable iCloud becomes. It's the glue that keeps them in sync.

If you ONLY use an iPhone



One device to keep backed up

- Mainly need iCloud for a phone backup
- A smaller (or free) plan may be enough
- Great fit for archiving photos to a drive

If you use iPhone + MacBook + iPad



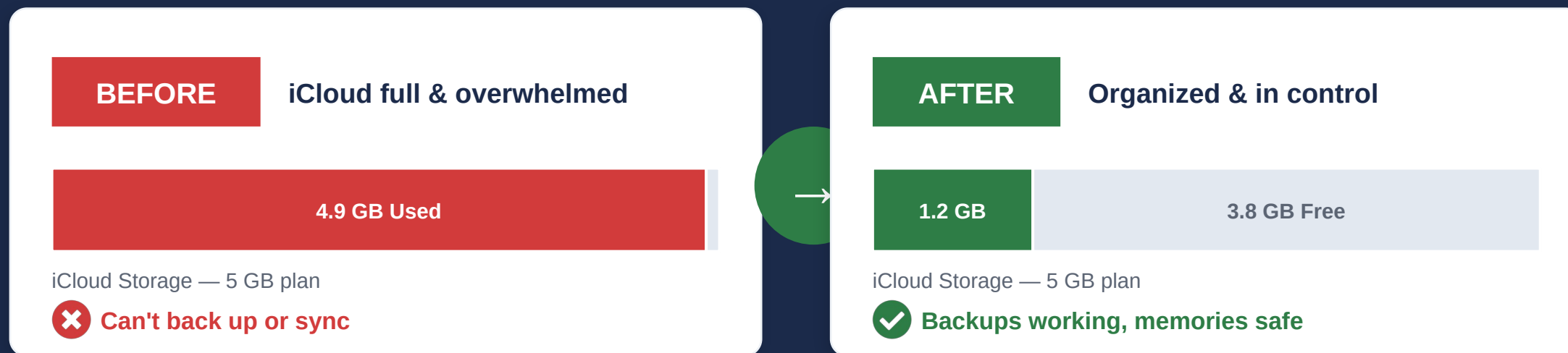
iCloud keeps them all in sync

- Take a photo once — it appears everywhere
- Photos, files, contacts & notes stay matched
- A larger plan is usually worth it here

The rule of thumb: one device = less cloud needed. Many devices = iCloud is the glue worth paying for.

How Photo Rescue Helps

We safely move your memories off your phone — freeing space without losing a thing.



Preserve
your memories



Archive photos
safely



Avoid paying for
extra storage



Free up space
on your iPhone

The Bottom Line



iPhone Storage

The space INSIDE your phone.



iCloud Storage

Apple's ONLINE storage.

They are separate — either one can become full on its own.

Ready to free up space and protect your memories?



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